

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 996

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the Revolutionary War veterans interred within the Great Smoky Mountains National Park and surrounding areas.

WHEREAS, as the United States marks its 250th birthday, citizens are called upon to celebrate not only our country's auspicious founding, but those who placed their lives in peril for the sake of the freedoms that we enjoy even today; and

WHEREAS, tens of millions of Americans have served in the Armed Forces of the United States from the American Revolution to present-day conflicts, and many of these veterans chose to settle in East Tennessee; some of these veteran settlers had their land taken from them for the establishment of the Great Smoky Mountains National Park; and

WHEREAS, many of these Revolutionary War veterans are buried within the bounds of the national park, including Henry Bohanan and William Hamby, as well as near the park, including Fredrick Emert, Spencer Clark, William Cocke, and the wives who supported the war efforts, including Mary Blount and Martha Dandridge Washington; and

WHEREAS, it is imperative that we not forget the sacrifices these men and women made for our country, including giving the ultimate sacrifice for our freedom; and

WHEREAS, these veterans were brave and selfless individuals who, when duty called, willingly put themselves in harm's way to defend the lives and liberty of others; their abiding patriotism and enduring devotion to the ideals on which the United States is founded continue to inspire us today; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we honor the memories of these individuals who fought valiantly so that America could become a sovereign nation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that, as we celebrate the 250th birthday of our nation, we honor the contributions of our Revolutionary War veterans to the principles of democracy, individual freedom, human rights, and the history of our State, especially those veterans whose final resting place is within and near the Great Smoky Mountains National Park.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.